



had the same exposure as those from the metros. In Tripura, we have recently integrated students into our workforce. Similarly, we are trying to educate the children of our housekeeping and security staff, give them an internship and finally, a job at Deloitte.

I believe true innovation comes from the youth.

When they're happy and engaged, when they find joy and purpose in what they do, their true potential is unleashed. When their energy gets channelised, we will see innovations happen.

I run a programme called 'Mics not Muted', where I go across the country and have met about 7,000 people. The format enables an open conversation with the objective to break hierarchies because that sometimes stifles innovation. We also try to instil a

sense of purpose in what we do. This sense of purpose drives real magic. **115**

Happiness is not an esoteric term of just people being happy. It impacts productivity, attendance, and even new product development. We have a concept called 'Backbenchers'. These are a bunch of very smart folks, who are driving a lot of the people initiatives and transformation across the firm. We're also breaking silos and bringing business expertise into internal functions. For example, our Chief People and Experience Officer is also a digital customer experience expert. Because we believe, understanding and connecting with our people is key to motivating them.

Q: In a country as large and as diverse as India, where do your people come from?

A: In the past, our workforce mainly consisted of individuals from the major cities, with backgrounds such as chartered accountancy, and institutions like the IITs and IIMs being the primary focus. However, things have changed. We're actively seeking talent from non-traditional backgrounds. What's impressive is the incredible drive and passion we're seeing in individuals from smaller cities and towns. They're making a significant impact and difference within our organisation. **BT**

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“At Deloitte we believe in the potential of the India Stack to transform business models for our clients, not only in the private sector, but also in the government”